

PARMIGIANO FONDUTA-FILLED TORTELLINI IN BRODO

SERVES
6-8

TOTAL TIME
5 h plus the dough rest

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Egg dough
474 g	Heavy cream
225 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated, for the filling
27 g	Egg yolks, stirred
1.6 to 1.8 kg	Chicken, whole
2.8 to 4.7 kg	Water
300 g	Carrots, peeled and cut into 1-inch pieces
370 g	Onion, quartered
227 g	Celery, cut into 1-inch pieces
150 g	Leek, cut into 1-inch pieces
30 g	Parsley
100 g	Garlic, head halved
9 g	Black peppercorns
1	Fresh bay leaf
45 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated, to finish
quantity not given	Salt
quantity not given	Olive oil
quantity not given	Black pepper

METHOD

- For the filling, bring the cream to a bare simmer in a saucepan over medium heat. Drop the heat to low and hold it there until the cream has reduced by a third, 1 to 1½ hours. Watch the bottom of the pan, it scorches easily. Let it stand 5 minutes.
- Pour the cream into a high-speed blender. Run it on low to medium and rain the parmigiano in slowly, until the mixture emulsifies. Taste before you salt, because the cheese brings a lot of salinity already.
- With the blender still turning, trickle the yolks in so they temper instead of splitting the mixture. Cover and refrigerate at least 1 hour. If it sits several hours or overnight, pull it out 30 minutes before you pipe so it softens.
- For the brodo, put the chicken in a large stockpot with 2.8 kg of the water, adding more if the bird is not covered. Bring it up to a simmer slowly over low heat, 45 minutes to 1 hour. Scum rises once it simmers. Skim it off continuously with a big spoon, which is what keeps the brodo clear.
- After an hour, top the pot up with the remaining water if the level has dropped below the chicken, then simmer 2 hours more, still skimming and still topping up as needed.
- Drop in the carrots, onion, celery, leek, garlic, parsley, peppercorns and bay leaf. Hold it at a slow simmer another 1 to 2 hours, until it tastes full.
- Line a fine-mesh strainer with cheesecloth, or with a coffee filter, and pass the brodo through it. Set 1.6 kg aside for this dish. Cool the rest and keep it in an airtight container, 5 days refrigerated or a month frozen. Save the chicken meat too.
- Make 90 to 120 tortellini with the egg dough and the fonduta.
- Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to the boil over high heat.
- While the water heats, warm the measured brodo in a saucepan over low heat and salt it to taste.
- Slide the tortellini into the water and pull the heat back to a gentle simmer. A rolling boil splits this filling. Cook 1 to 2 minutes. The thickest closure should give tenderly and the fonduta inside should have gone molten and creamy.
- Lift them out with a spider or pasta basket into bowls, ladle the brodo over and finish with a drizzle of oil, pepper to taste and the parmigiano.

NOTES

The fonduta is parmigiano, cream and enough yolk to bind, with no wine and no flour. It is piped cold and melts in the pot to the texture of a runny yolk.
 Skim the brodo the whole way through. Clarity is the point of the dish.
 Add the yolks in a thin stream with the blender running. Dumped in, they break the emulsion.
 Filling that has been refrigerated overnight needs half an hour at room temperature before it will pipe.
 Late in autumn this gets white truffle shaved over the top, but it stands up without.

FILLING

Parmigiano Fonduta Filling

INGREDIENTS

474 g	Heavy cream
225 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
27 g	Egg yolks, stirred
quantity not given	Salt

METHOD

1. Bring the cream to a bare simmer in a saucepan over medium heat.
2. Drop the heat to low and hold it there until the cream has reduced by a third, 1 to 1½ hours. Watch the bottom of the pan, it scorches easily.
3. Let the cream stand 5 minutes.
4. Pour it into a high-speed blender. Run the blender on low to medium and rain the parmigiano in slowly, until the mixture emulsifies. Taste before you salt, because the cheese brings a lot of salinity already.
5. With the blender still turning, trickle the yolks in so they temper instead of splitting the mixture.
6. Cover and refrigerate at least 1 hour before piping.

NOTES

No wine and no flour. This fonduta is cheese, reduced cream and enough yolk to bind. It is piped cold and melts in the pot, finishing with the texture of a runny egg yolk. The yolks go in as a thin drizzle with the blender running. Dumped in, they break the emulsion. Filling held several hours or overnight needs 30 minutes out of the refrigerator before it will pipe. Reducing the cream slowly over 1 to 1½ hours is deliberate. A scorched pan bottom carries straight into the filling.

SHAPE

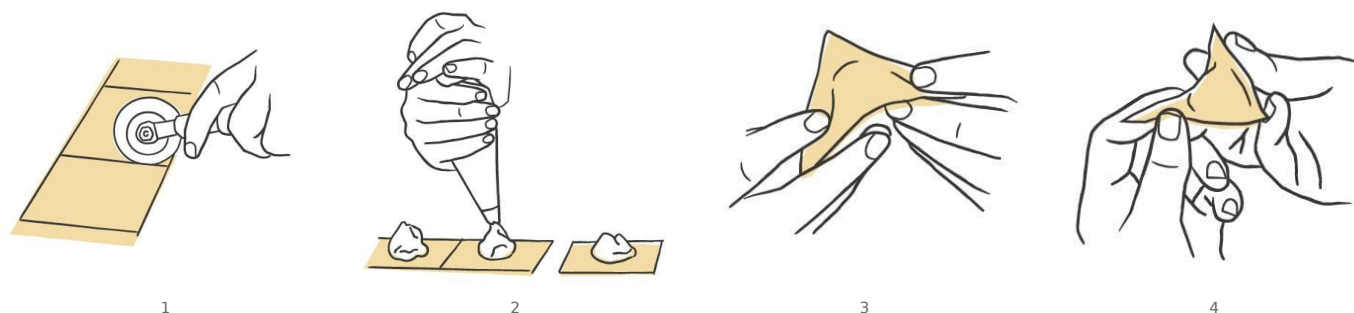
Tortellini

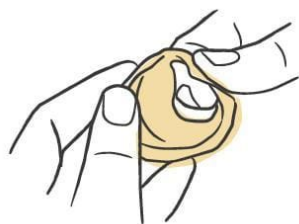
Region: Emilia-Romagna, primarily Modena and Bologna / Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

METHOD

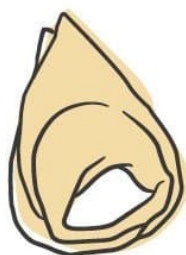
1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Lay one sheet on the board. Cut it into 1 3/4-inch squares with a straight-edged dough divider. A plain pastry cutter with a ruler, or a knife with a ruler, works too. Keep the squares under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Load the filling into a pastry bag cut to a 1/4-inch opening. Pipe a hazelnut-sized circle of filling into the center of each square. With a dense filling such as meat, pinch off each portion and place it by hand instead.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist the squares with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Hold a square in your palm and fold one corner over to the opposite corner, lining up the edges, to make a triangle.
7. Pinch the edge shut around the filling with thumb and index finger. Work back and forth a few times and push all the air out.
8. Take the bottom tips of the triangle between thumb and index finger. Wrap one side around your other index finger until the two tips meet beneath the filling in a ring. Pinch that joint tight, then flatten it to roughly the thickness of the rest of the piece so it cooks evenly.
9. Set the piece on the prepared pan. Fill and fold the rest of the squares, keeping them in a single layer, and dust the pan again with semolina.
10. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
11. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

SHAPING





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NOTES

Sheet is cut into 1 3/4-inch squares with a straight-edged dough divider, the smallest square in this group, with plain edges.
 Filling per piece: a hazelnut-sized amount piped through a 1/4-inch opening, or pinched off and placed by hand if the filling is dense.
 Seal geometry: fold corner to corner into a triangle, pinch the edge closed, then wrap the two bottom tips around your index finger so they meet at the underside of the filling and form a ring. The ring closes tight against the filling, with no gap, which is what separates it from balanzoni.
 No dimple step. The shape goes straight from the pinched edge to the ring.
 The finished joint gets flattened to the thickness of the rest of the piece for even cooking.
 Air must be forced out of the edge as you pinch.
 Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
 Served in brodo, unadorned. Filling is nearly always cured meat plus ground pork, veal, or chicken, with parmigiano and nutmeg.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

- Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
- Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
- Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
- Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
- Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
- Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
- Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
- Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
 Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
 Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
 Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____

RATING ____ / 5

OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____